

DJANGO

When Python Bites the Web



Here's how to start using Django for Web application development.

Quoting Wikipedia, “software frameworks aim to facilitate software development by allowing designers and programmers to devote their time to meeting software requirements rather than dealing with the more standard low-level details of providing a working system, thereby reducing overall development time.”

Rails is one of the most famous Web application development frameworks on top of the Ruby programming language. Django, on the other hand, is an advanced Web programming framework built on top of Python. Django is a strong competitor of Ruby on Rails.

Django abstracts lots of background details, like the SQL database, by providing higher-level interfaces. It is a very handy framework and a quick solution to build any complex Web application. If you are already familiar with the Python programming language, you would find it easy to hack with Django.

Let us get started

We will now look at how to get started with Django. You need the Django development server to work with it. Download the development server from www.djangoproject.com

and install it as follows:

```
$ wget http://www.djangoproject.com/download/1.1.1/tarball/
$ tar xzvf Django-1.1.1.tar.gz
$ cd django-1.1.1
$ sudo python setup.py install
```

...or on Ubuntu:

```
$ sudo apt-get install python-django
```

On installation, certain Django utilities like *django-admin* and *manage.py* will be available. We will use these tools throughout the development process.

Now let us dig into the basics. A Django project is an environment where we deploy the Django server. A Django project may contain more than one application. Here, there are Django Web applications that are sub-grouped as different modules. You will understand the distinction between a Django project and application in detail when we look at the code.

You can create a new Django project using the *django-admin* command:

```
slayan@hackbox:~/FPS$ django-admin startproject helloworld
slayan@hackbox:~/FPS$ cd helloworld/
```